



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trivium School

School Website: <https://triviumschool.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Trivium School, Lancaster, MA 01523, presents a robust Catholic classical education that clearly aligns with the Six Essential Elements framework. The school openly espouses a Catholic metaphysical vision, foregrounds virtue and wisdom as aims of education, and implements a curriculum anchored in the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; plus quadrivium), Great Books/primary texts, and the Great Conversation. Pedagogy centers on Socratic discussion in the upper grades and a strong fine-arts emphasis, with a culture of reverence for liturgy and communal practice (Mass weekly, chapel, Benedictine monastery connections). The faculty structure emphasizes mentors and a living curriculum, and community engagement is evidenced through open houses and parent participation opportunities. Across all six categories, the evidence supports a CLASSICAL classification, with explicit signals of religious formation, formation-centered aims, a canonical curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, a faculty modeled as the living curriculum, and active parent/community involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission foregrounds a Catholic framework, aiming to form students through a pathway of truth, goodness, and beauty, and cites perennial principles embedded in Graeco-Roman, Judeo-Christian culture. - Public materials describe Trivium as a Catholic school loyal to Sacred Scriptures and Holy Tradition via the Magisterium. - Communal liturgical practices are documented (Mass attended weekly as a school, a school chapel on campus). - The school emphasizes liturgical life and reverence in its culture and mission statements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; Catholic; theology; liturgy; Mass; Sacred Scriptures; Holy Tradition; Magisterium; chapel. - Negative keywords: None observed in public materials.

Why this rating - Multiple explicit statements connect education to transcendent, objective goods (truth, goodness, beauty) and embed theological grounding with liturgical/community practices. This combination strongly satisfies the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission speaks of forming students in the pathways of truth, goodness, and beauty, signaling formation over mere information. - Public materials describe education as formation oriented toward virtue and wisdom rather than mere job-preparation, aligning with the long-standing classical aim of human excellence. - Language around authentic knowledge (truth, goods, beauty) appears as a central aim, not instrumental mathematics of success alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, human excellence, timeless principles. - Negative keywords: None observed.

Why this rating - The school explicitly positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, anchored in the objective realities of truth, goodness, and beauty, fulfilling the Element 2 criteria.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A Classical Curriculum is stated, built on the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and quadrivium (sciences and mathematics). - The curriculum emphasizes reading and discussing “Great Works” and primary texts, with a focus on the “Great Conversation.” - Socratic Learning is identified as the method, with emphasis on the study of primary texts and active intellectual formation. - The curriculum includes a Senior Thesis and a Fine Arts component, underscoring integration of humanities and arts in the classical framework. - Specific course content shown in the Classes section demonstrates liberal arts content (grammar, Latin, life of Christ, theology, chorus, art/music, etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Quadrivium; Great Books; primary texts; Great Conversation; wonder; integration; thesis; fine arts; chorus; Latin; Latin 1–4; Sacraments; Theology. - Negative keywords: None observed.

Why this rating - The school’s materials align with core curriculum indicators of classical education: liberal arts structure, Great Books/primary texts, integration across disciplines, and a culminating senior rhetoric project, confirming a CLASSICAL designation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic Learning is highlighted as the primary method for the fixed curriculum, with emphasis on dialectic discussion and active student thinking. - Upper- and high-school pedagogy includes seminars, debates, and opportunity for rhetoric and public speaking; the Senior Thesis and defense cultivate rhetoric. - In lower grades, the program includes collaborative arts (chorus, drama, music), and memory-based learning with singing, aligns with a contemplative/restful dimension that complements rigorous work. - The presence of formal liturgical life (Mass, chapel) reinforces the integration of contemplation and community ritual into pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic learning; seminars; debates; rhetoric; public speaking; Great Books/discussions; memory through chant/singing; contemplative/restful aspects; integration of arts. - Negative keywords: None observed.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogy strongly demonstrates classical practices: Socratic dialogue in the upper grades, a rhetoric-focused capstone (Senior Thesis), and lower-grade engagement through chant/music, aligning with the Pedagogy criteria.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Headmaster and a dedicated Dean of Faculty are highlighted, with a clear leadership structure and a small but focused faculty; the school notes the number of full-time and part-time tutors. - The Headmaster’s biography emphasizes long tenure, classical training, and teaching across history and theology, illustrating the model-mentor teacher profile. - The faculty is described as the living curriculum, with teachers deeply engaged in forming students across grades (e.g., English, theology, language, science, etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; core/center of the school; a small, dedicated faculty; leadership by Headmaster; professional expertise. - Negative keywords: None observed.

Why this rating - Public materials portray an intentionally intimate, teacher-centered model where faculty act as mentors, the living curriculum, and the core of the school’s identity, meeting the Element 5 criteria.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly invites and hosts events for families, including a yearly Open House, signaling parental engagement and transparency. - The school provides channels for parent involvement and participation through communications and gatherings (e.g., NHS-related information shows structured adult involvement in school life). - Public pages emphasize that Trivium School is a community of students, faculty, parents, and friends, underscoring a community-centered model with parent participation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partners with parents; co-teachers with the school; book studies; gatherings; open visits for parents; parent involvement; community events. - Negative

keywords: None observed.

Why this rating - The school positions itself as a community-centered institution with ongoing parental involvement and opportunities for parent education and engagement, aligning with the Parents & Community criteria.

Aggregate assessment - Across all six categories, the Trivium School adheres closely to classical criteria: strong religious/metaphysical grounding; formation-focused purpose; a curriculum built on liberal arts and Great Books; Socratic and rhetoric-based pedagogy; a faculty described as the living curriculum and mentors; and active parent/community engagement. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL rating across all categories. If desired, minor enhancements could include:
- More explicit, public statements detailing the role of parents as co-teachers and extended family involvement, to further crystallize Element 6 signals.
- Additional public documentation of “Great Conversation” integration across more grade levels to strengthen Element 3 evidence.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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